A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO YOUR LOCAL FILE ORGANIZER

Sanctum Keeper

How watched folders are scanned, how rules choose actions, and how file changes are reviewed and protected.

LOCAL-FIRST	PREVIEW BEFORE ACTION	CHECKSUM-VERIFIED

The short version

Keeper watches up to three folders that you choose. It records file observations and waits until a file is unchanged across two scans. Enabled rules are checked in order; the first matching rule is shown in a dry-run preview. Nothing is changed by preview alone. After you confirm, a queued worker rechecks the file and performs the selected action while recording a history entry.

Separate from watched folders, File Inventory can be started on demand to recursively scan mounted drives and produce a paginated file listing with totals and type counts.

What this guide covers

- Watched-folder setup and the two-scan stability check.
- Rule order, matching conditions, schedules, and available actions.
- Dry-run previews, confirmation, background execution, history, and undo.
- The separate whole-device inventory and its scan limitations.

1. Watched folders and scanning

A watched folder is a location Keeper checks for files to organize. The app allows up to three watched folders. Folder paths are validated as existing directories; system and root locations are rejected.

What one scan does

Step	What Keeper does
1. Check availability	If the folder is missing or its drive is disconnected, Keeper marks it offline and does not process files there.
2. Read direct children	The watcher enumerates files directly inside the selected folder. This watcher does not recursively descend into subfolders.
3. Skip unsafe/noisy entries	Directories, symbolic links, dot-prefixed files, and names ending in .tmp, .part, or .crdownload are skipped.
4. Record observation	For each eligible file, Keeper records its path, size, last-modified timestamp, and how many consecutive scans have seen those details unchanged.
5. Require stability	A new or changed file starts at one stable scan. It becomes eligible after the same size and modified timestamp are seen on a later scan (at least two stable scans).
6. Reconcile	After a successful folder scan, observations for files no longer present are removed, and the folder scan time is updated.

The optional keeper:watch command repeats watched-folder scans every two seconds. The scheduled keeper:scan task also runs every minute when Laravel scheduling is active. These are scanning cycles; actual changes still depend on rules, approval, preview, and a queue worker.

Important distinction

Watched-folder scanning is designed to notice settled files in the folder you selected, not to inventory everything below that location. Use File Inventory when you need a recursive overview of mounted drives.

2. Rules: how Keeper chooses what to do

Rules are ordered from top to bottom. Only enabled rules are considered. For a file, Keeper tests rules in priority order and uses the first match; lower rules are not considered for that file.

Conditions you can match

Field	Meaning	Examples of operators
Name	The file name, compared without case sensitivity.	contains, equals, starts with, ends with
Extension	The extension, compared without case sensitivity.	equals, contains, starts with, ends with
Size	File size in bytes.	equals, greater than, less than
Age	Age in days, calculated from the file modified timestamp.	equals, greater than, less than

Conditions can be combined with AND, OR, or NOT. Nested groups are supported. Each rule has a maximum of 12 conditions in a group, nesting is limited to four levels, and the validator caps total condition nodes at 60.

Available actions

Action	Behavior and safeguards
Rename	Renames in the same folder. Enter a file name, not a path.
Move	Moves into an existing destination folder. Keeper does not overwrite an existing destination file.
Copy	Copies into an existing folder and verifies the copied content. The original remains in place.
Move to Keeper trash	Moves the file to Keeper's recoverable holding location.
Run custom command	Runs locally with the staged file path in KEEPER_FILE and a 10-second timeout. Commands run without an operating-system sandbox; use only commands you trust. Script actions cannot be undone by Keeper.

A rule can run when a settled file arrives, or on an hourly/daily sweep. The first matching enabled rule still wins. Editing rule order or enabled status clears approvals so the updated behavior must be previewed again.

3. Preview, confirmation, and safe execution

Preview scan reads one watched folder, updates stability observations, evaluates stable files against the rule list, and displays the proposed rule and destination. Preview itself does not move, rename, copy, trash, or edit the files.

When you confirm a preview

- Keeper checks that the watched folder is still available.
- For each planned file, it checks that the file still exists and that its modified timestamp, size, and SHA-256 checksum still match the preview.
- It re-evaluates the first matching rule. Plans that no longer match are skipped.
- The rule is marked approved by the confirmation and the action is queued for the organizer worker.

Before the action runs

The worker independently checks the file timestamp and checksum again, verifies that the same rule is still the first match and is approved, and applies a loop guard to prevent repeatedly organizing the same destination. If the file changed or the rule no longer qualifies, the job is ignored or failed rather than applying a stale plan.

File actions are recorded in an append-only ledger with the source, destination, action, checksum, and result. Move/copy operations verify their result. The activity view displays outcomes and errors. Retry is available for failed executions.

Undo and recovery

Completed move/rename/trash actions can be undone when the recorded destination still exists and its checksum is unchanged. Undo stops if the original location is occupied or the file content differs. Undoing a copy removes the verified copy; the original is kept. Custom script actions are not undoable. If the app is interrupted mid-action, the recovery task reconciles pending ledger entries from source and destination checksums.

If an action is skipped

Common reasons include: the file changed after preview; the checksum no longer matches; another rule became the first match; approval was reset by a rule change; the destination already exists; or a previous action already handled the file. Check Activity & undo for execution status and details.

4. Whole-device File Inventory

File Inventory is a separate, on-demand feature. Choose Scan device to queue a recursive scan of mounted drive roots. On Windows, Keeper checks drive letters A: through Z: and scans roots that are mounted. On other platforms, it scans from the filesystem root.

The inventory scan is broader than watched-folder scanning. It recursively visits accessible directories, records file name, full path, extension, size, and timestamps, and reports total files, total bytes, PDF count, and counts by extension. Results are paginated in the UI.

- Symbolic links and non-file entries are skipped; links are not followed.
- Directories that cannot be read are skipped and counted. A scan can take a long time and will not include inaccessible content.
- Inventory runs in a queue job. A queue worker must process the default queue for it to start; file actions use the organizer queue.
- A completed scan replaces the previous stored inventory. While a new scan is running, the previous completed report remains available.

About timestamps

The inventory stores the creation/change timestamp supplied by the operating system API, plus the modified timestamp. On Windows, the creation timestamp normally represents file creation. On Unix-like systems, the underlying ctime is a metadata-change time, not necessarily the original creation date.

Quick reference

Need	Use
Organize files from a chosen location	Add a watched folder, create/enable rules, preview a folder, then confirm.
See all files and PDF totals across drives	Open File Inventory and choose Scan device.
Check why a change did not happen	Open Activity & undo and review its status/error.
Safely reverse an eligible file action	Use Undo from the activity ledger, provided the file still matches its recorded checksum.

Keeper is local-first: file paths and operations are handled by the local app. Keep previews enabled and use custom commands only when you understand what they do.